

Hello, world!

A Programming Language

Two Variables

- `x`, `y`

Three Operations

- `x++`
- `x--`
- `x = 0 ? L1 : L2`

Example Program

(What does it do?)

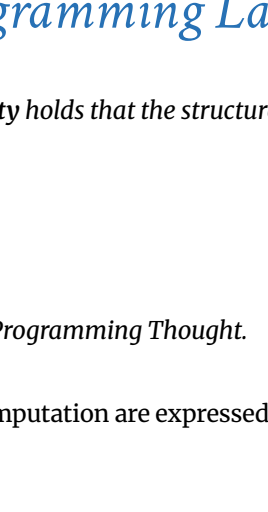
```
L1: x++
    y--
    y = 0 ? L2 : L1
L2: ...
```

The above language is “equivalent to” every PL!

But good luck writing

- ... QuickSort
- ... Fortnite
- ... Spotify!

So Why Study Programming Languages?



Federico Fellini

A different language is a different vision of life.

So Why Study Programming Languages?

The principle of *linguistic relativity* holds that the structure of a language affects its speakers world view or cognition.

Or more simply:

Programming Language shapes Programming Thought.

Language affects how ideas and computation are expressed

Course Goals

CSE8	
CSE12	
CSE100	
CSE130	

130 Brain

New languages come (and go ...)

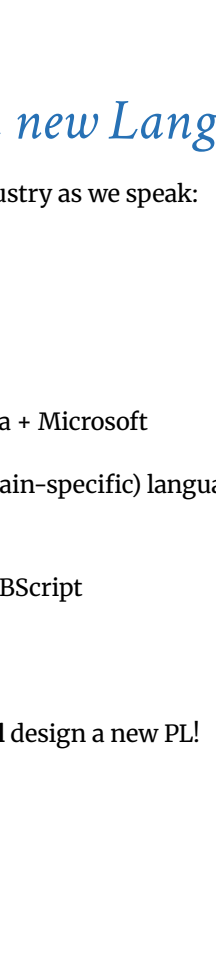
There was no

- Java 30 years ago
- C# 25 years ago
- Rust 15 years ago
- WebAssembly 5 years ago

What is CSE 130 about?

- Concepts in programming languages
- Programming paradigms
- Language design and implementation

Goal: Learn the Anatomy of PL



Anatomy

- What makes a programming language?
- Which features are **fundamental** and which are syntactic sugar?

Goal: Learn New Languages / Constructs



Musical Score

New ways to describe and organize computation, to create programs that are:

- **Correct**
- **Readable**
- **Extendable**
- **Reusable**

Goal: How to Design new Languages

New languages being designed in industry as we speak:

- Flow, React @ Facebook
- Rust @ Mozilla
- TypeScript @ Microsoft
- Swift @ Apple
- WebAssembly @ Google + Mozilla + Microsoft

Buried in every large system is a (domain-specific) language

- DB: SQL
- Word, Excel: Formulas, Macros, VBScript
- Emacs: LISP
- Latex, shell scripts, makefiles, ...

If you work on a large system, you will design a new PL!

Goal: Enable You To Choose Right PL

But isn't that decided by

- Libraries
- Standards
- Hiring
- Your Boss?!

Yes.

My goal: Educate tomorrow's leaders so you'll make **informed** choices.

What is CSE 130 not about?

Learning...

- JavaScript in January
- Haskell in February
- C++ in March

etc.

The Crew

Profs

Ranjit Jhala

- Professor at CSE since 2005
- Research: Tools and Techniques to make programs better

The Crew

Teaching Assistants

- Cole Kurashige

Tutors

- Yuehua Xie
- Alain Zhang

Course Syllabus

Functional Programming

- Lambda calculus (2 weeks)
- Functional Programming (4 weeks)
- Building an Interpreter (3 weeks)

Logic Programming

- Prolog (-1 week, maybe, but doubtful!)

QuickSort in C

```
void sort(int arr[], int beg, int end){
    if (end > beg + 1){
        int piv = arr[beg];
        int l = beg + 1;
        int r = end;
        while (l != r-1)
            if(arr[l] <= piv) l++;
            else swap(&arr[l], &arr[r--]);
        if(arr[l]<=piv && arr[r]<=piv)
            l=r+1;
        else if(arr[l]<=piv && arr[r]>piv)
            {l++; r--;}
        else if (arr[l]>piv && arr[r]<=piv)
            swap(&arr[l++], &arr[r--]);
        else r=l-1;
        swap(&arr[r-1], &arr[beg]);
        sort(arr, beg, r);
        sort(arr, l, end);
    }
}
```

QuickSort in Haskell

```
sort [] = []
sort (x:xs) = sort ls ++ [x] ++ sort rs
  where
    ls = [ l | l <- xs, l < x ]
    rs = [ r | r <- xs, x < r ]
```

(Note: not a wholly [fair comparison](#)...)

Course Logistics

[webpage](#)

- Calendar
- Lecture notes
- Programming assignments

[piazza](#)

- Go-to place if you have a question or need help

Policies

- No podcasting.
- No screens (phones, laptops) in lecture.
- Yes attendance & class participation (worksheets).
- Yes exams must be done at allotted time and location.

Grading

- 10% Class participation (*worksheets*)
- 30% Programming Assignments (*codespaces*)
- 30% Two Midterm **Tu 1/27** and **Thu 2/19** (*in lecture*)
- 30% Final **Tu 3/18**
- 05% Piazza Extra Credit (*top 5 best participants*)

Class participation (10%)

- “In class” worksheets handed out each lecture
- Handed in at the end of the lecture
- Turn in 75% of the worksheets to get full credit
- Responses will be graded on participation (not correctness)

Assignments (30%)

6 programming assignments

- Released [online](#)
- At least a week before due date
- Via github classroom + codespaces

Six late days

- used as **whole unit**
- 5 mins late = 1 late day
- at most 4 per assignment

No Groups

- Assignments must be submitted individually via github
- Ok to discuss with classmates, but solution must be your own

Exams (15 + 15 + 30%)

- Must be done at allotted time and location
- 2-sided ``cheat sheet”
- The final is cumulative

Your Resources

Discussion section

- Th 6:00-6:50pm (CENTER 212)

Office hours

- Every day, check **CANVAS calendar**

Piazza

- We answer during work hours and office hours (M-F)

No text

- Online lecture notes and links

Academic Integrity

Programming assignments: do not copy from classmates or from previous years

Exams done **alone**

- Zero Tolerance
- Offenders punished ruthlessly
- Please see academic integrity statement

Students with Disabilities

Students requesting accommodations for this course due to a disability or current functional limitation must provide a current **Authorization for Accommodation (AFA)** letter issued by the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD) which is located in University Center 202 behind Center Hall.

Students are required to present their AFA letters to Faculty (please make arrangements to contact me privately) and to the CSE OSD Liaison [Christina Rontell](#) in advance so that accommodations may be arranged.

Lambda Calculus

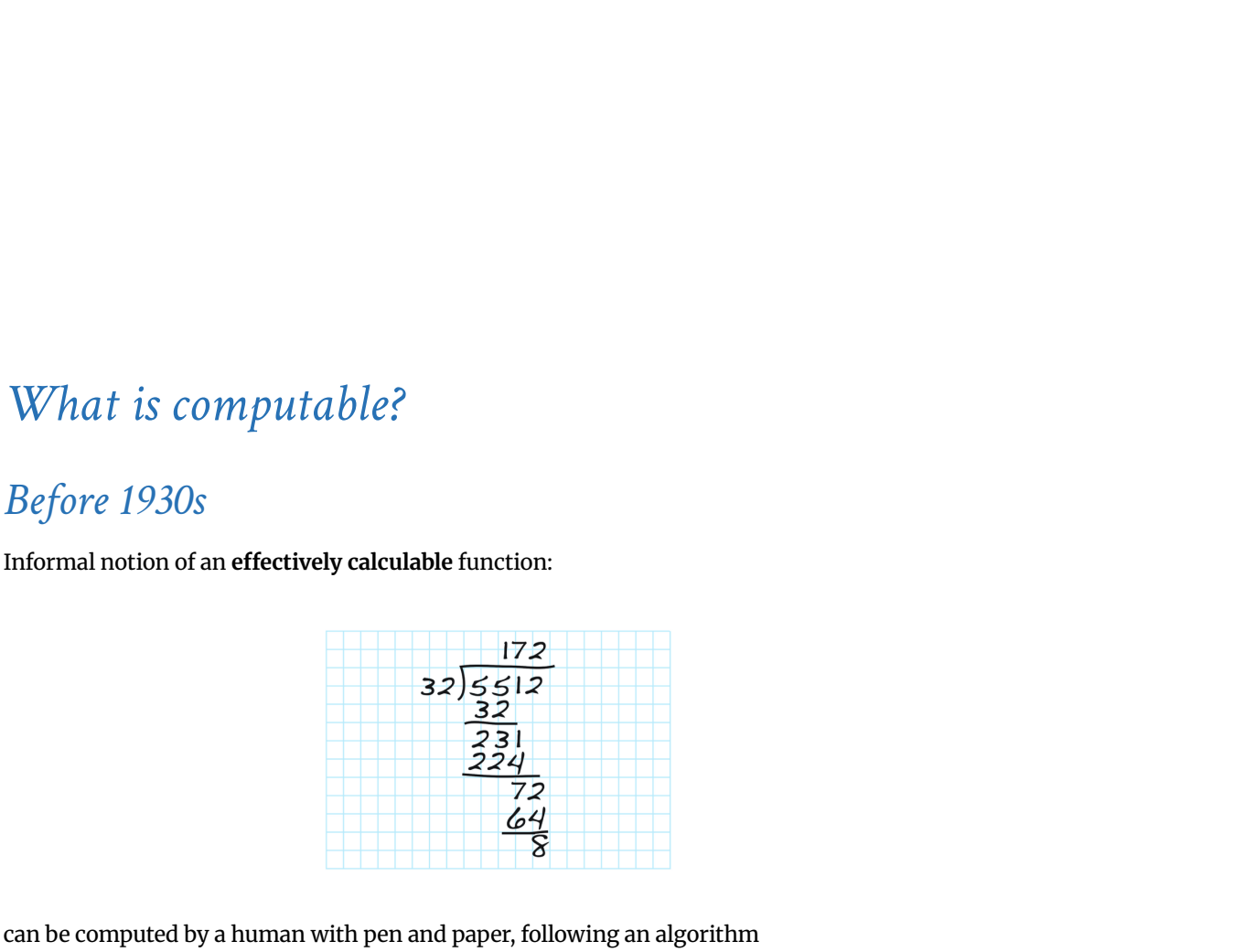
Your Favorite Language

Probably has lots of features:

- ~~Assignment~~ (~~$x \leftarrow x + 1$~~)
- ~~Booleans, integers, characters, strings, ...~~
- ~~Conditionals~~
- ~~Loops~~
- ~~Return, break, continue~~
- **Functions**
- ~~Recursion~~
- ~~References / pointers~~
- ~~Objects and classes~~
- ~~Inheritance~~
- ...

Which ones can we do without?

What is the **smallest universal language**?



What is computable?

Before 1930s

Informal notion of an **effectively calculable function**:



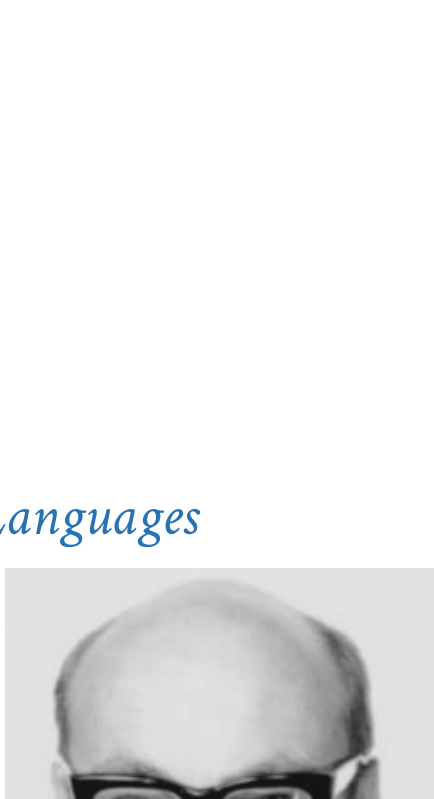
can be computed by a human with pen and paper, following an algorithm

1936: Formalization

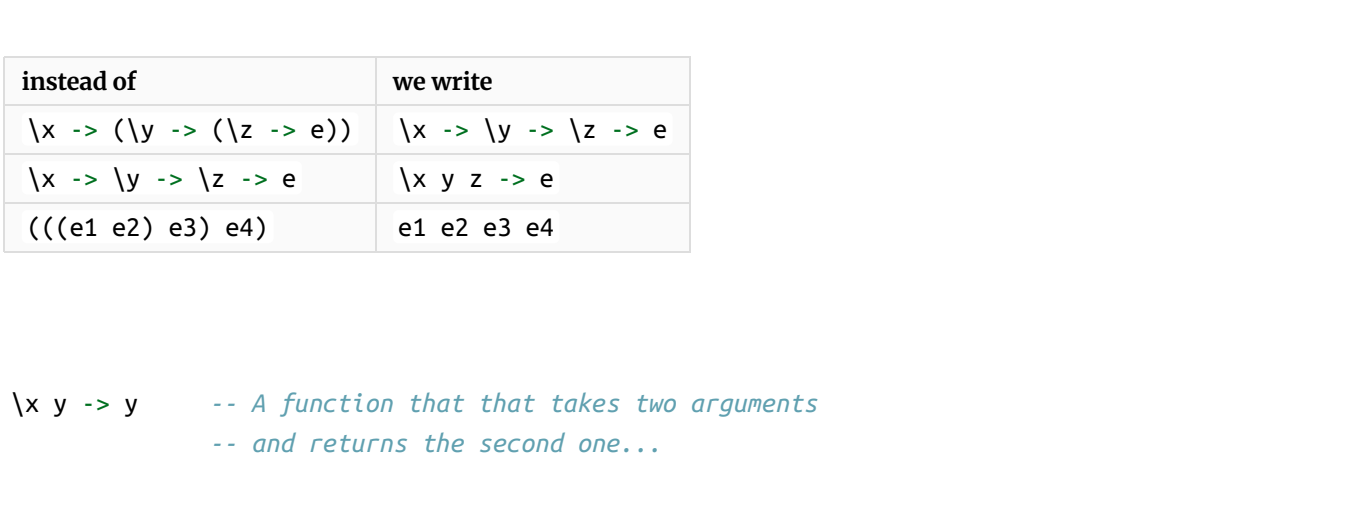
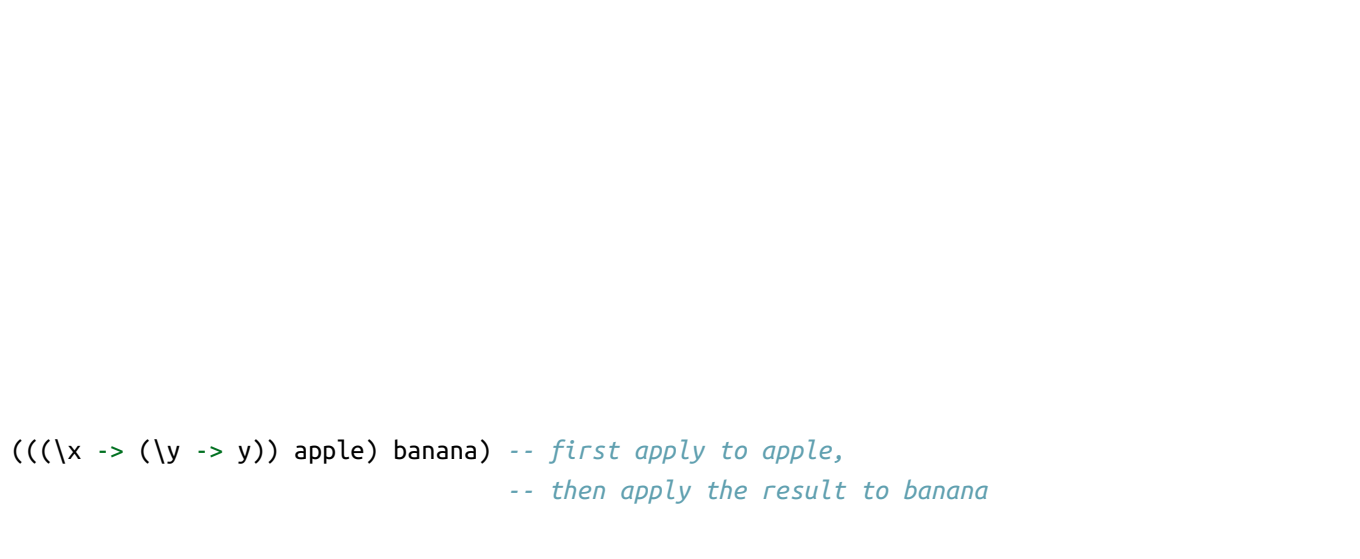
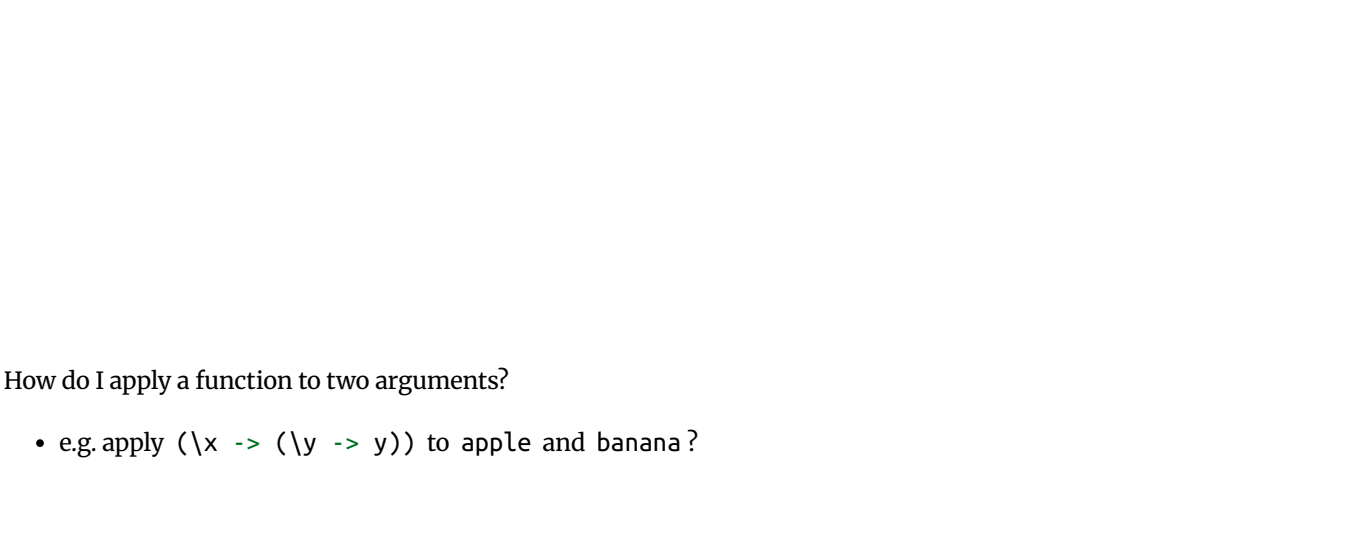
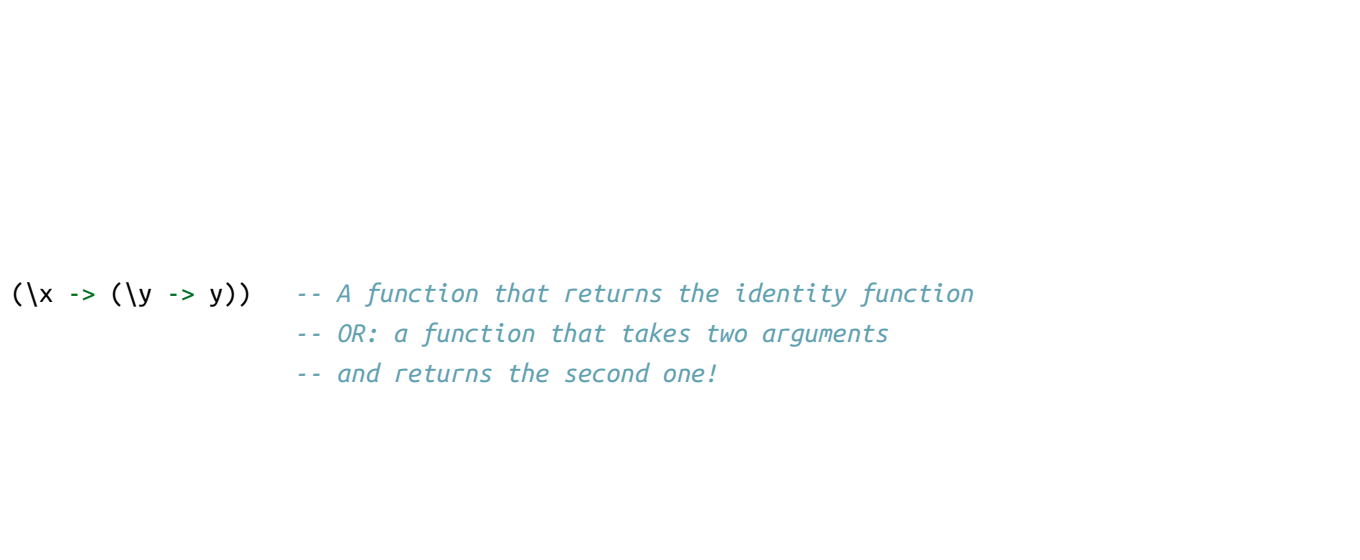
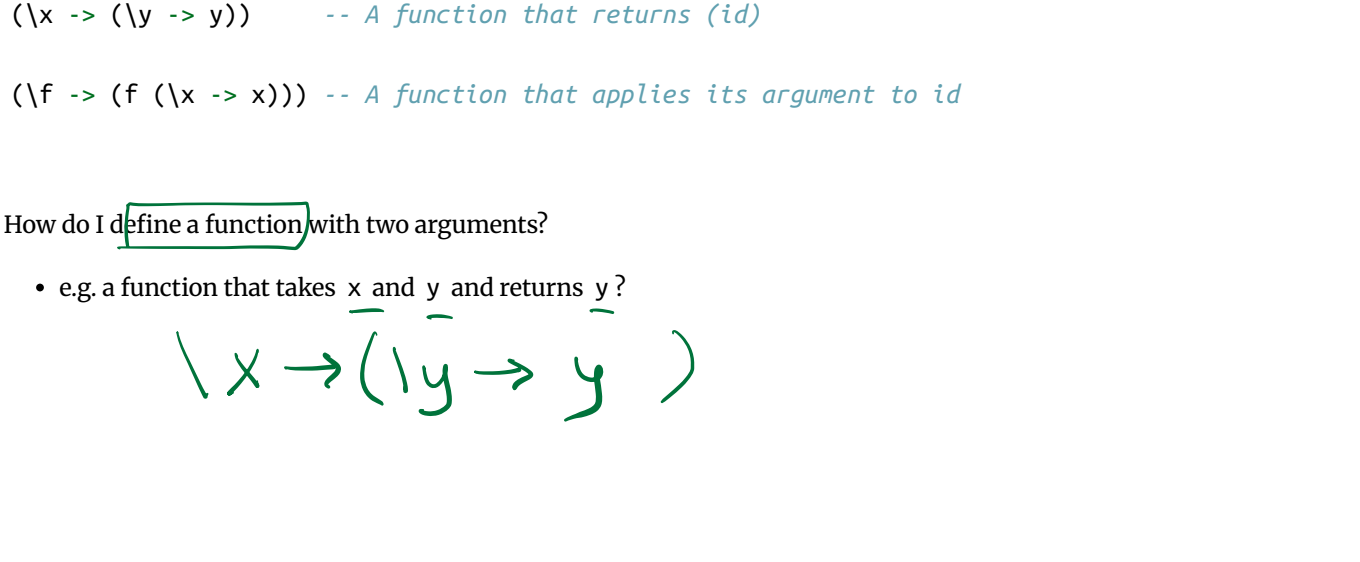
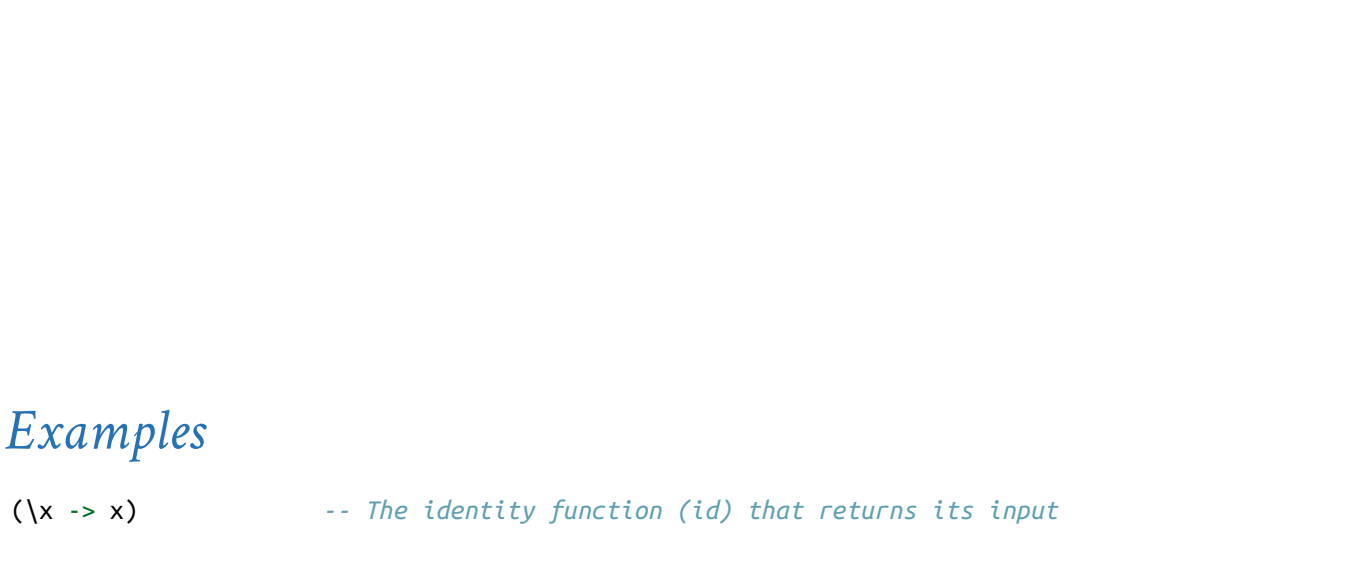
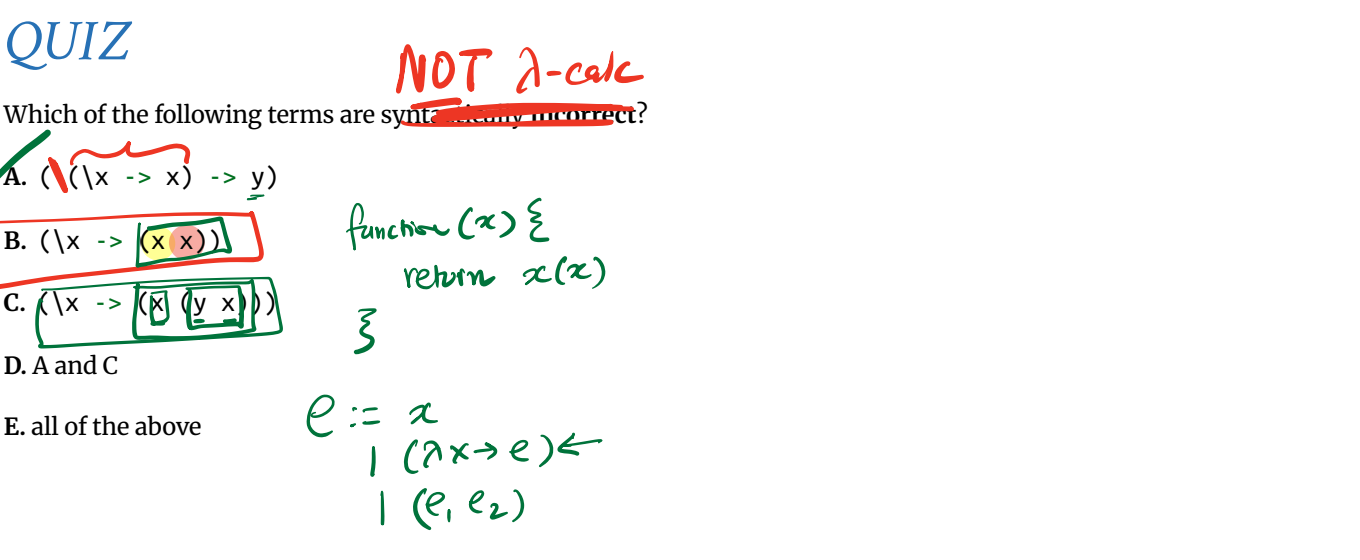
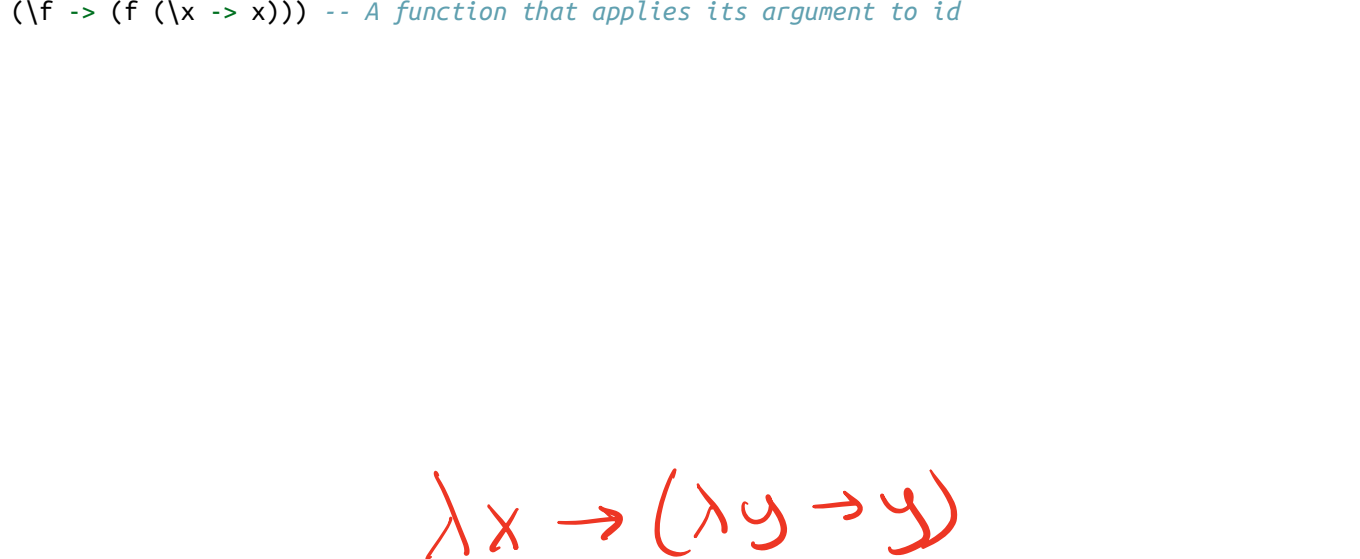
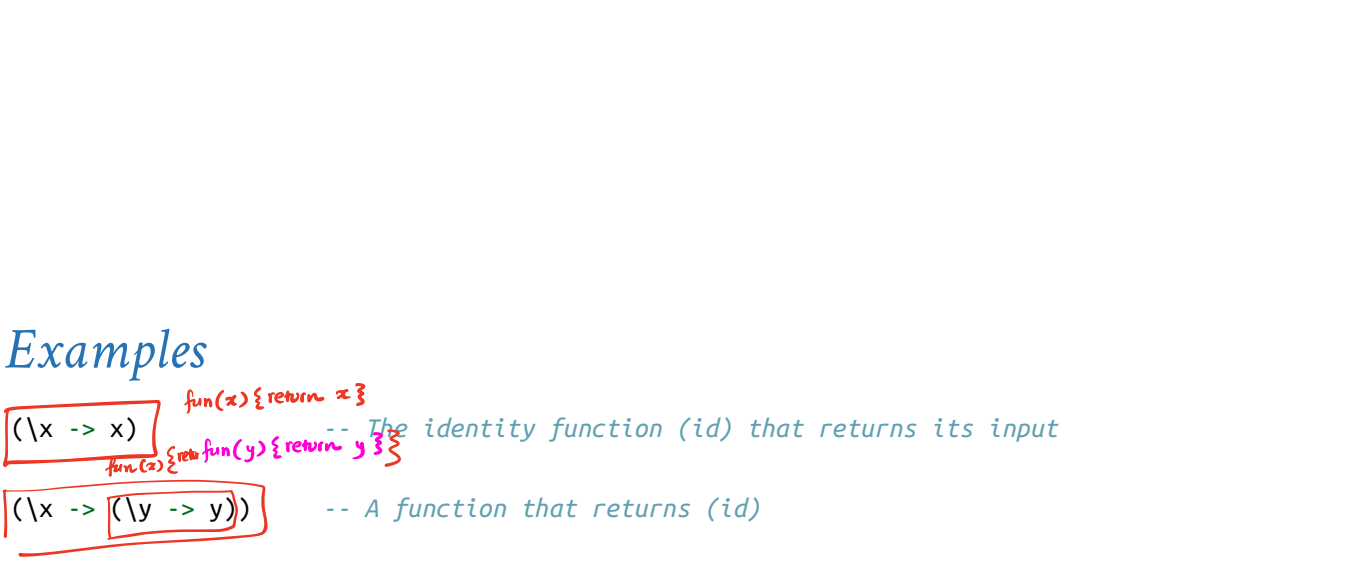
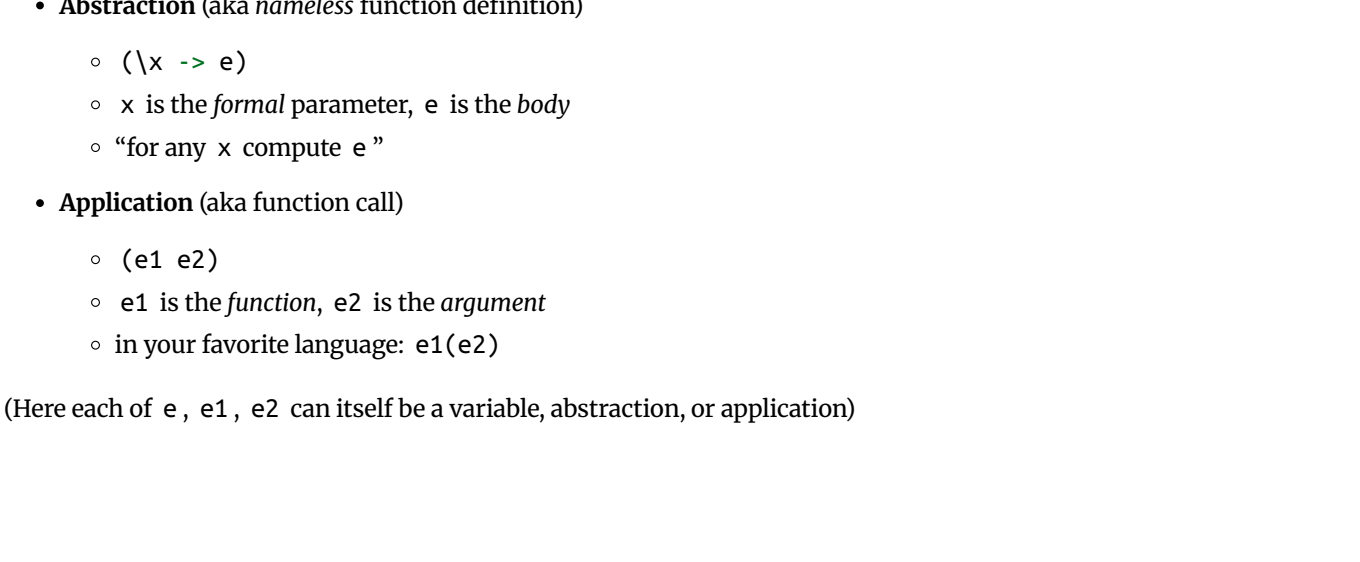
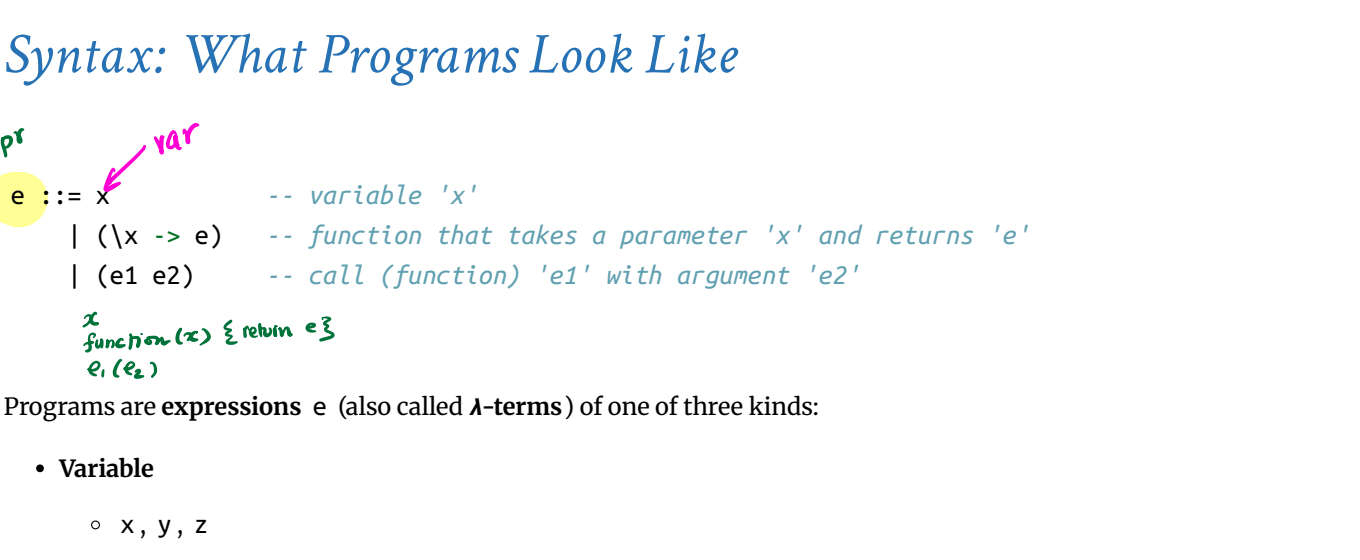
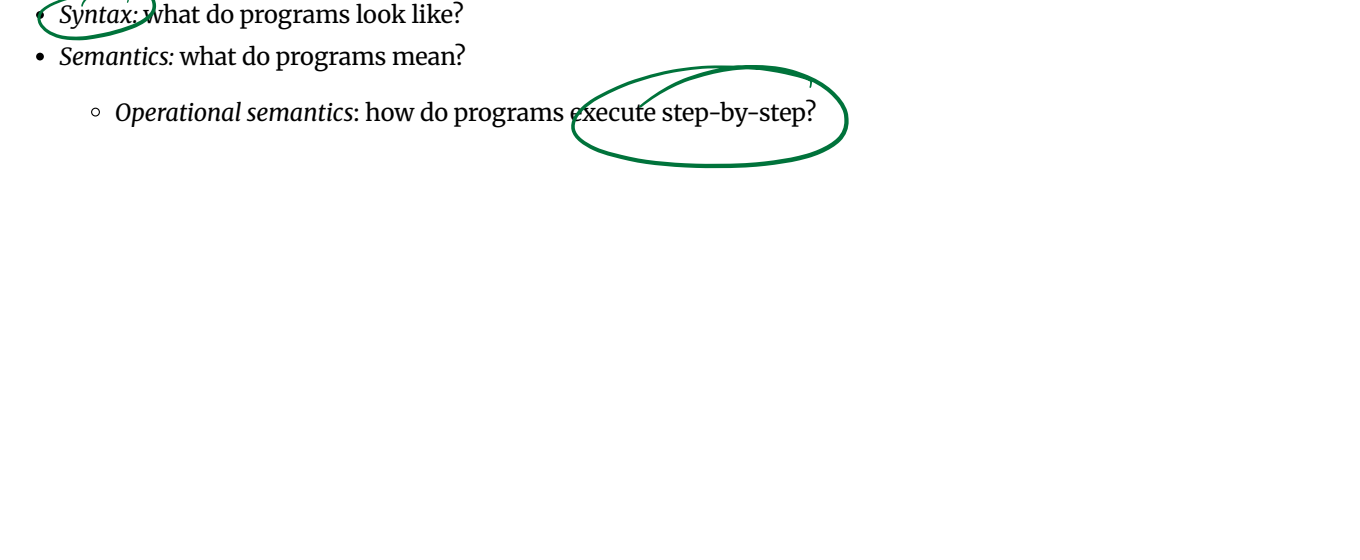
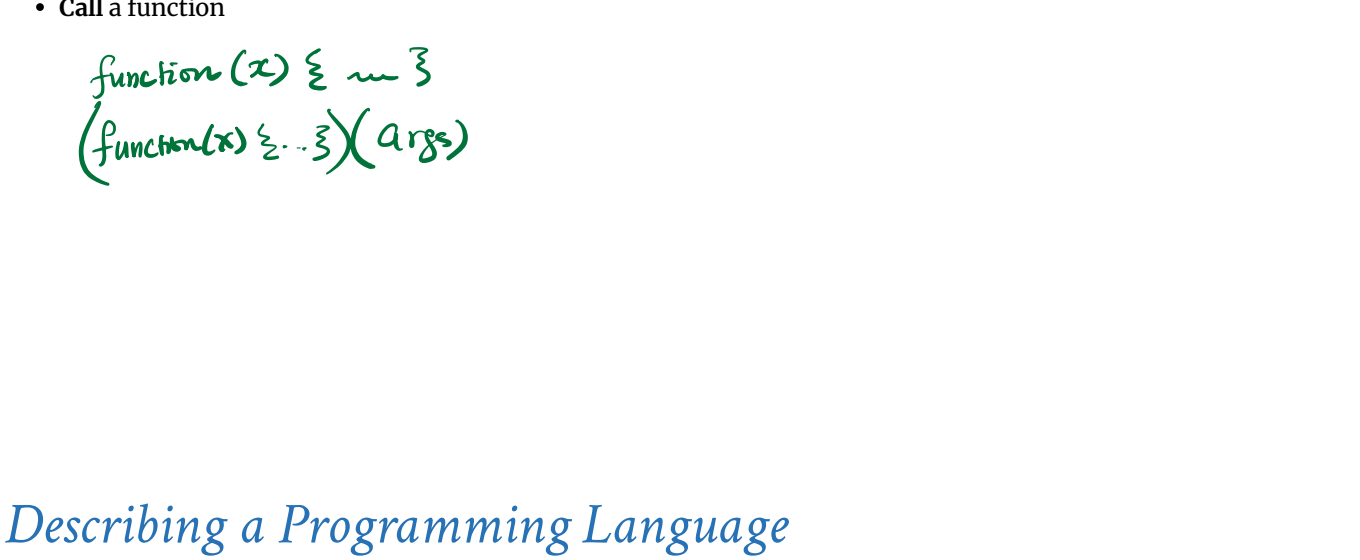
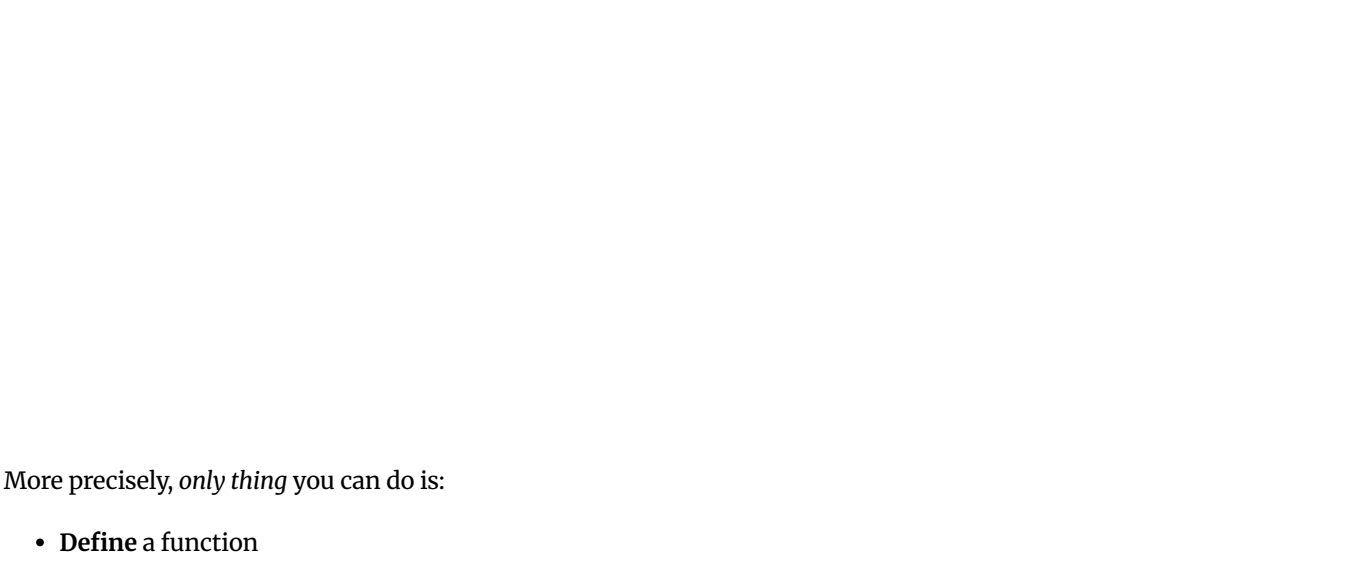
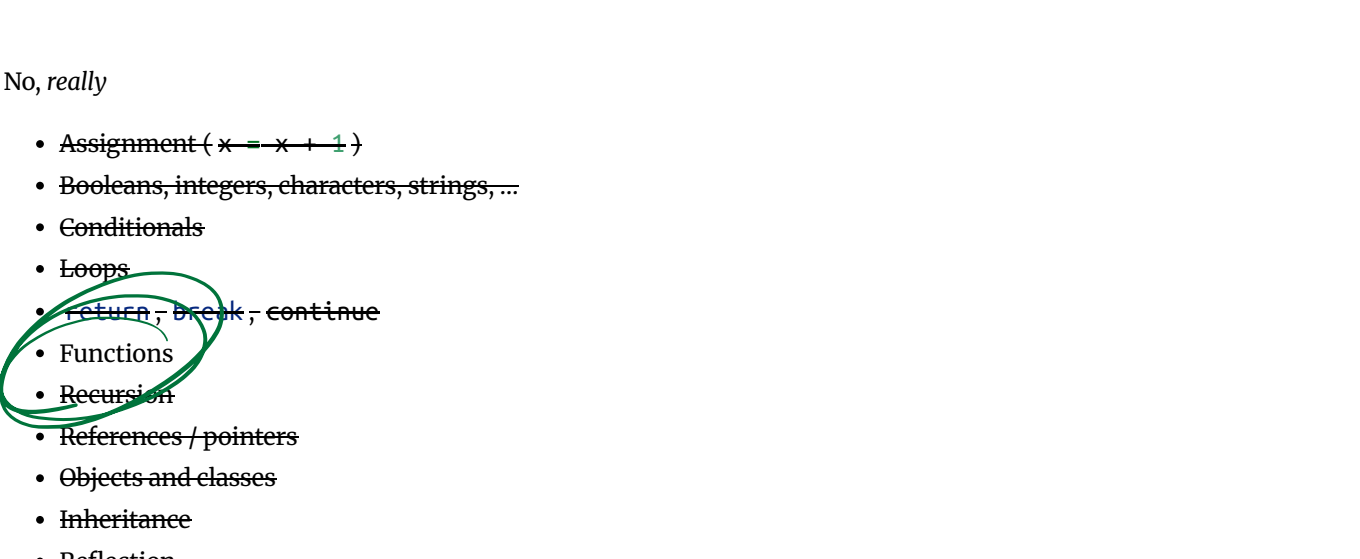
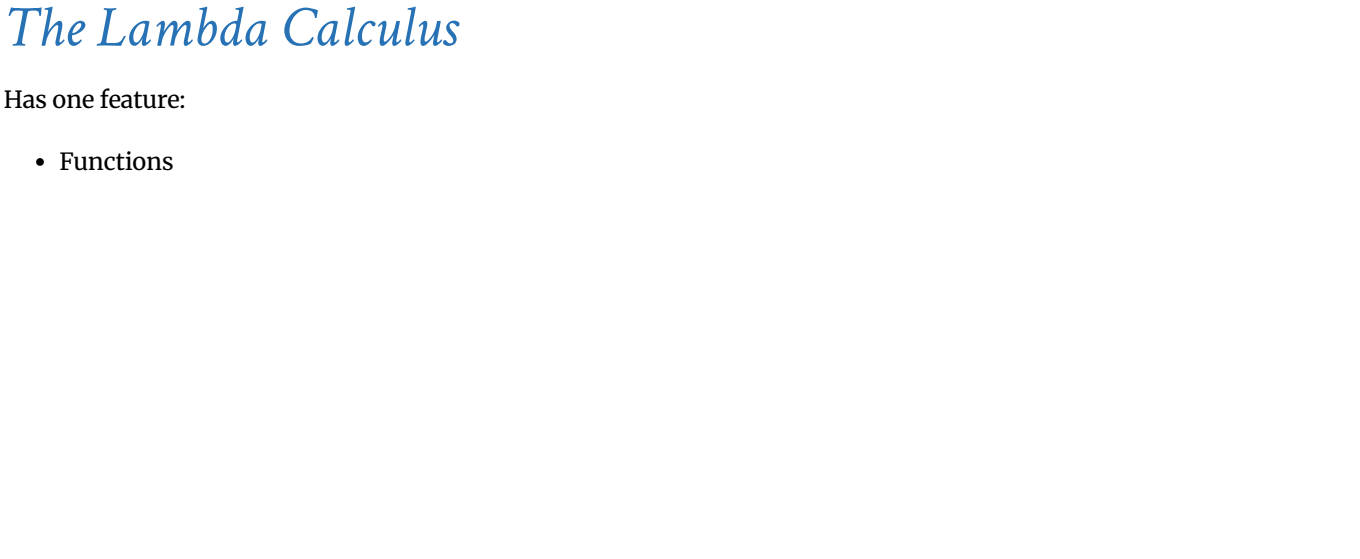
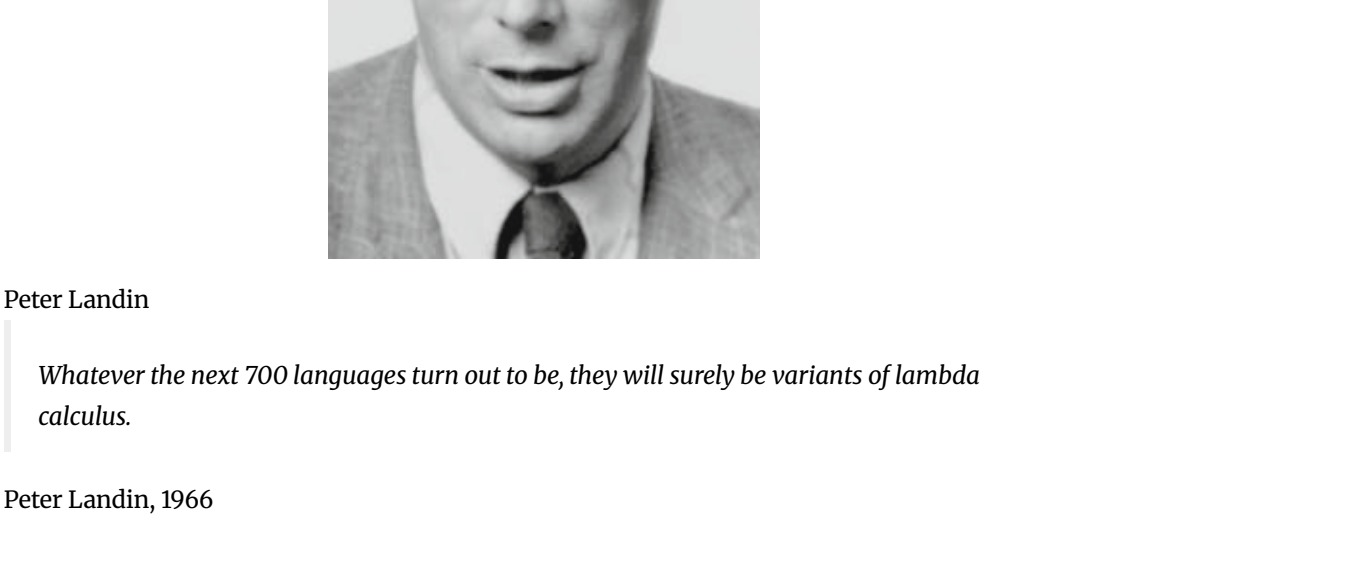
What is the **smallest universal language**?



Alan Turing



Alonzo Church



$\lambda x y \rightarrow y$ -- A function that that takes two arguments
-- and returns the second one...

Syntactic Sugar

instead of	we write
$\lambda x \rightarrow (\lambda y \rightarrow (\lambda z \rightarrow e))$	$\lambda x \rightarrow \lambda y \rightarrow \lambda z \rightarrow e$
$\lambda x \rightarrow \lambda y \rightarrow \lambda z \rightarrow e$	$\lambda x \ y \ z \rightarrow e$
$((e1 \ e2) \ e3) \ e4$	$e1 \ e2 \ e3 \ e4$

$\lambda x y \rightarrow y$ -- A function that that takes two arguments
-- and returns the second one...

$(\lambda x\ y\ \rightarrow y)$ apple banana $\rightarrow \dots$ applied to two arguments

Semantics: What Programs Mean

How do I “run” / “execute” a λ -term?

Think of middle-school algebra:

```
((3 * 8) - 2)
==
3 * ((3 * 8) - 2)
==
3 * (24 - 2)
==
3 * 22
==
66
```

Execute = rewrite step-by-step

- Following simple rules
- until no more rules apply

Rewrite Rules of Lambda Calculus

- β -step (aka function call)
- α -step (aka renaming formals)

But first we have to talk about **scope**

Semantics: Scope of a Variable

The part of a program where a variable is **visible**

In the expression $(\lambda x \rightarrow e)$ $\text{fun}(x) \{ e \}$

- x is the newly introduced variable
- e is the **scope** of x
- any occurrence of x in $(\lambda x \rightarrow e)$ is **bound** (by the binder λx)

For example, x is bound in:

```
(\lambda x -> x)
(\lambda x -> (\lambda y -> x))
```

An occurrence of x in e is **free** if it's not bound by an enclosing abstraction

For example, x is free in:

```
(x y)           -- no binders at all!
(\lambda y -> (x y))  -- no \x binder
((\lambda x -> )(\lambda y -> y)) x  -- x is outside the scope of the \x binder;
                           -- intuition: it's not "the same" x
```

QUIZ

Is x bound or free in the expression $((\lambda x \rightarrow x) x)$?

- A. first occurrence is bound, second is bound
- B. first occurrence is bound, second is free
- C. first occurrence is free, second is bound
- D. first occurrence is free, second is free

EXERCISE: Free Variables

An variable x is **free** in e if there exists a free occurrence of x in e

We can formally define the set of all free variables in a term like so:

```
FV(x)      = ???
FV(\x -> e) = ???
FV(e1 e2)  = ???
```

Closed Expressions

If e has no free variables it is said to be **closed**

- Closed expressions are also called **combinators**

What is the shortest closed expression?

$\lambda x. x$

$\hat{x}. e \quad \wedge x. e \quad \lambda x. c$

$e ::= x, y, z \mid \lambda x. e \mid e_1 e_2$
 $\uparrow \quad \quad \uparrow \quad \quad \uparrow$
 $\text{var} \quad \text{fun}(x) \{ \text{ret } e \} \quad e_1(e_2)$

Rewrite Rules of Lambda Calculus

- β -step (aka function call)
- α -step (aka renaming formals)

Semantics: Redex

A redex is a term of the form

```
((\lambda x -> e1) e2)
```

A function $(\lambda x \rightarrow e1)$

- x is the *parameter*
- $e1$ is the *returned expression*

Applied to an argument $e2$

- $e2$ is the *argument*

Semantics: β -Reduction

A redex β -steps to another term ...

```
(\lambda x -> e1) e2 =b> e1[x := e2]
```

where $e1[x := e2]$ means

“ $e1$ with all free occurrences of x replaced with $e2$ ”

Computation by **search-and-replace**:

If you see an abstraction applied to an argument,

- In the *body* of the abstraction
- Replace all *free occurrences* of the *formal* by that *argument*

We say that $(\lambda x \rightarrow e1) e2$ β -steps to $e1[x := e2]$

$(\lambda x \rightarrow x) \text{ apple} \Rightarrow \text{apple}$
 $(\lambda x \rightarrow e_1) e_2$

Redex Examples

```
((\lambda x -> x) apple)
```

=b> apple

Is this right? Ask [Elsa](#)

QUIZ

```
((\lambda x -> ((\lambda y -> y) y)) apple)
```

=b> ???

- A. apple
- B. $\lambda y \rightarrow \text{apple}$
- C. $\lambda x \rightarrow \text{apple}$
- D. $\lambda y \rightarrow y$
- E. $\lambda x \rightarrow y$

QUIZ

```
(\lambda x -> (((\lambda y -> y) y) x)) apple
```

=b> ???

- A. $((\text{apple } \text{apple}) \text{apple}) \text{apple}$
- B. $(((\text{y } \text{apple}) \text{y}) \text{apple})$
- C. $(((\text{y } \text{y}) \text{y}) \text{y})$
- D. apple

QUIZ

```
((\lambda x -> ((\lambda x -> x) x)) apple)
```

=b> ???

- A. $(\text{apple } (\lambda x \rightarrow x))$
- B. $(\text{apple } (\text{apple } \rightarrow \text{apple}))$
- C. $(\text{apple } (\lambda x \rightarrow \text{apple}))$
- D. apple
- E. $(\lambda x \rightarrow x)$

EXERCISE

What is a λ -term fill_this_in such that

fill_this_in apple
=b> banana

ELSA: <https://elsa.goto.ucs.d.edu/index.html>

[Click here to try this exercise](#)

A Tricky One

```
((\lambda x -> ((\lambda y -> x) y)) y)
```

=b> $\lambda y \rightarrow y$

Is this right?

Something is Fishy

(\x -> (\y -> x)) y

=b> (\y -> y)

Is this right?

Problem: The free y in the argument has been captured by \y in body!

Solution: Ensure that *formals* in the body are different from *free-variables* of argument!

Capture-Avoiding Substitution

We have to fix our definition of β -reduction:

(\x -> e1) e2 => e1[x := e2]

where $e1[x := e2]$ means " $e1$ with all free occurrences of x replaced with $e2$ "

- $e1$ with all free occurrences of x replaced with $e2$
- as long as no free variables of $e2$ get captured

Formally:

$x[x := e] = e$

$y[x := e] = y$ -- as $x \neq y$

$(e1\ e2)[x := e] = (e1[x := e])\ (e2[x := e])$

$(\lambda x \rightarrow e1)[x := e] = (\lambda x \rightarrow e1)$ -- Q: why leave 'e1' unchanged?

$(\lambda y \rightarrow e1)[x := e]$
| not (y in FV(e)) = $\lambda y \rightarrow e1[x := e]$

Oops, but what to do if y is in the free-variables of e ?

- i.e. if $\lambda y \rightarrow \dots$ may capture those free variables?

Rewrite Rules of Lambda Calculus

- 1. β -step (aka function call)
- 2. α -step (aka renaming formals)

Semantics: α -Renaming

$\lambda apple \rightarrow y$ $\lambda y \rightarrow y$

$\lambda x \rightarrow e \Rightarrow \lambda y \rightarrow e[x := y]$
where not (y in FV(e))

$\lambda x \rightarrow y$ $\lambda x' \rightarrow y$

- We rename a formal parameter x to y
- By replace all occurrences of x in the body with y
- We say that $\lambda x \rightarrow e$ α -steps to $\lambda y \rightarrow e[x := y]$

Example:

$(\lambda x \rightarrow x) \Rightarrow (\lambda y \rightarrow y) \Rightarrow (\lambda z \rightarrow z)$

All these expressions are α -equivalent

What's wrong with these?

-- (A)
 $(\lambda f \rightarrow (f\ x)) \Rightarrow (\lambda x \rightarrow (x\ x))$

-- (B)
 $((\lambda x \rightarrow (\lambda y \rightarrow y))\ y) \Rightarrow ((\lambda x \rightarrow (\lambda z \rightarrow z))\ z)$

Tricky Example Revisited

$((\lambda x \rightarrow (\lambda y \rightarrow x))\ y)$ -- rename 'y' to 'z' to avoid capture

$\Rightarrow (\lambda x \rightarrow (\lambda z \rightarrow x))\ y$ -- now do β -step without capture!

$\Rightarrow (\lambda z \rightarrow y)$

- To avoid getting confused,
- you can always rename formals,
 - so different variables have different names!

Normal Forms

Recall **redex** is a λ -term of the form

$((\lambda x \rightarrow e1)\ e2)$

A λ -term is in **normal form** if it contains no redexes.

QUIZ

Which of the following term are not in normal form ?

- A. x ✓
- B. $(x\ y)$ ✓
- C. $((\lambda x \rightarrow x)\ y)$ ✗
- D. $(x\ (\lambda y \rightarrow y))$ ✓
- E. ~~$(\lambda x \rightarrow x)$~~

Semantics: Evaluation

A λ -term e **evaluates to** e' if

1. There is a sequence of steps

$e \Rightarrow^? e_1 \Rightarrow^? \dots \Rightarrow^? e_N \Rightarrow^? e'$

where each $\Rightarrow^?$ is either $\Rightarrow a$, $\Rightarrow b$, or $\Rightarrow d$ and $N \geq 0$

2. e' is in normal form

Examples of Evaluation

$((\lambda x \rightarrow x)\ apple)$

$\Rightarrow b \Rightarrow apple$

$(\lambda f \rightarrow f\ (\lambda x \rightarrow x))\ (\lambda x \rightarrow x)$

$\Rightarrow ? \Rightarrow ???$

$(\lambda x \rightarrow x\ x)\ (\lambda x \rightarrow x)$

$\Rightarrow ? \Rightarrow ???$

Elsa shortcuts

Named λ -terms:

let $ID = (\lambda x \rightarrow x)$ -- abbreviation for $(\lambda x \rightarrow x)$

To substitute name with its definition, use a $\Rightarrow d$ step:

$(ID\ apple)$
 $\Rightarrow d \Rightarrow ((\lambda x \rightarrow x)\ apple)$ -- expand definition
 $\Rightarrow b \Rightarrow apple$ -- beta-reduce

- Evaluation:
- $e1 \Rightarrow^* e2$: $e1$ reduces to $e2$ in 0 or more steps
 - where each step is $\Rightarrow a$, $\Rightarrow b$, or $\Rightarrow d$
 - $e1 \Rightarrow^{\rightarrow} e2$: $e1$ evaluates to $e2$ and $e2$ is in **normal form**

EXERCISE

Fill in the definitions of **FIRST**, **SECOND** and **THIRD** such that you get the following behavior in `elsa`

$(x_1 \rightarrow (x_2 \rightarrow (x_3 \rightarrow BAN)))$

let **FIRST** = fill_this_in
let **SECOND** = fill_this_in
let **THIRD** = fill_this_in

$((((e_1\ e_2)\ e_3)\ e_4)\ e_5)$

eval ex1 :
 $((FIRST\ apple)\ banana)\ orange$
 $\Rightarrow^* apple$

eval ex2 :
 $((SECOND\ apple)\ banana)\ orange$
 $\Rightarrow^* banana$

eval ex3 :
 $((THIRD\ apple)\ banana)\ orange$
 $\Rightarrow^* orange$

ELSA: <https://elsa.goto.ucsd.edu/index.html>

[Click here to try this exercise](#)

Non-Terminating Evaluation

$((\lambda x \rightarrow (x\ x))\ (\lambda x \rightarrow (x\ x)))$

$\Rightarrow b \Rightarrow ((\lambda x \rightarrow (x\ x))\ (\lambda x \rightarrow (x\ x)))$

Some programs loop back to themselves ... never reduce to a normal form!

This combinator is called Ω

Programming in λ -calculus

Real languages have lots of features

- Booleans
- Records (structs, tuples)
- Numbers
- Lists
- **Functions** [we got those]
- Recursion

Lets see how to *encode* all of these features with the λ -calculus.

Syntactic Sugar

instead of	we write
$\lambda x \rightarrow (\lambda y \rightarrow (\lambda z \rightarrow e))$	$\lambda x \rightarrow \lambda y \rightarrow \lambda z \rightarrow e$
$(\lambda x \rightarrow \lambda y \rightarrow \lambda z \rightarrow e$	$\lambda x\ y\ z \rightarrow e$
$((e1\ e2)\ e3)\ e4)$	$e1\ e2\ e3\ e4$

$\lambda x\ y \rightarrow y$ -- A function that that takes two arguments
 -- and returns the second one..

$(\lambda x\ y \rightarrow y)\ apple\ banana$ -- ... applied to two arguments


```
let TRUE = \x1→\x2→x1
let FALSE = \x1→\x2→x2
let ITE = \b→\x1→\x2→(b x1) x2
```

ITE *TRUE* *apple* *banana*
→ *apple*
ITE *FALSE* *apple* *banana*
→ *banana*

λ-calculus: Booleans

How can we encode Boolean values (`TRUE` and `FALSE`) as functions?

Well, what do we do with a Boolean `b`?

Make a binary choice

- `if b then e1 else e2`

Booleans: API

We need to define three functions

```
let TRUE  = ???
let FALSE = ???
let ITE   = \b x y -> ???  -- if b then x else y
```

such that

```
ITE TRUE apple banana ==> apple
ITE FALSE apple banana ==> banana
```

(Here, `let NAME = e` means `NAME` is an abbreviation for `e`)

Booleans: Implementation

```
let TRUE  = \x y -> x           -- Returns its first argument
let FALSE = \x y -> y           -- Returns its second argument
let ITE   = \b x y -> b x y     -- Applies condition to branches
                                   -- (redundant, but improves readability)
```

Example: Branches step-by-step

```
eval ite_true:
  ITE TRUE e1 e2
=> (\b x y -> b x y) TRUE e1 e2  -- expand def ITE
=> (\x y -> TRUE x y) e1 e2      -- beta-step
=> (\y -> TRUE e1 y) e2          -- beta-step
=> TRUE e1 e2                   -- expand def TRUE
=> (\x y -> x) e1 e2             -- beta-step
=> (\y -> e1) e2                 -- beta-step
=> e1
```

Example: Branches step-by-step

Now you try it!

Can you fill in the blanks to make it happen?

```
eval ite_false:
  ITE FALSE e1 e2

-- fill the steps in!

=> e2
```

EXERCISE: Boolean Operators

ELSA: <https://elsa.goto.ucsd.edu/index.html> [Click here to try this exercise](#)

Now that we have `ITE` it's easy to define other Boolean operators:

```
let NOT = \b -> ???
let OR  = \b1 b2 -> ???
let AND = \b1 b2 -> ???
```

When you are done, you should get the following behavior:

```
eval ex_not_t:
  NOT TRUE ==> FALSE

eval ex_not_f:
  NOT FALSE ==> TRUE

eval ex_or_ff:
  OR FALSE FALSE ==> FALSE

eval ex_or_ft:
  OR FALSE TRUE ==> TRUE

eval ex_or_ft:
  OR TRUE FALSE ==> TRUE

eval ex_or_tt:
  OR TRUE TRUE ==> TRUE

eval ex_and_ff:
  AND FALSE FALSE ==> FALSE

eval ex_and_ft:
  AND FALSE TRUE ==> FALSE

eval ex_and_ft:
  AND TRUE FALSE ==> FALSE

eval ex_and_tt:
  AND TRUE TRUE ==> TRUE
```

Programming in λ-calculus

- Booleans [done]
- Records (structs, tuples)
- Numbers
- Lists
- Functions [we got those]
- Recursion

λ-calculus: Records

Let's start with records with two fields (aka **pairs**)

What do we do with a pair?

1. Pack two items into a pair, then
2. Get first item, or
3. Get second item.

Pairs : API

We need to define three functions

```
let PAIR = \x y -> ???  -- Make a pair with elements x and y
                        -- { fst : x, snd : y }
let FST  = \p -> ???    -- Return first element
                        -- p.fst
let SND  = \p -> ???    -- Return second element
                        -- p.snd
```

such that

```
eval ex_fst:
  FST (PAIR apple banana) ==> apple

eval ex_snd:
  SND (PAIR apple banana) ==> banana
```

Pairs: Implementation

A pair of `x` and `y` is just something that lets you pick between `x` and `y`!

```
let PAIR = \x y -> (\b -> ITE b x y)
```

i.e. `PAIR x y` is a function that

- takes a boolean and returns either `x` or `y`

We can now implement `FST` and `SND` by "calling" the pair with `TRUE` or `FALSE`

```
let FST = \p -> p TRUE  -- call w/ TRUE, get first value
let SND = \p -> p FALSE -- call w/ FALSE, get second value
```

```
let ex1 =
  FST3 (TRIPLE apple banana orange)
=> apple

eval ex2:
  SND3 (TRIPLE apple banana orange)
=> banana

eval ex3:
  THD3 (TRIPLE apple banana orange)
=> orange
```

EXERCISE: Triples

How can we implement a record that contains **three** values?

ELSA: <https://elsa.goto.ucsd.edu/index.html>

[Click here to try this exercise](#)

```
let TRIPLE = \x y z -> ???
let FST3   = \t -> ???
let SND3   = \t -> ???
let THD3   = \t -> ???

eval ex1:
  FST3 (TRIPLE apple banana orange)
=> apple

eval ex2:
  SND3 (TRIPLE apple banana orange)
=> banana

eval ex3:
  THD3 (TRIPLE apple banana orange)
=> orange
```

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λ-calculus: Numbers

Let's start with **natural numbers** (0, 1, 2, ...)

What do we do with natural numbers?

- Count: 0, inc
- Arithmetic: dec, +, -, *
- Comparisons: ==, <=, etc

Natural Numbers: API

We need to define:

- A family of **numerals**: `ZERO`, `ONE`, `TWO`, `THREE`, ...
- Arithmetic functions: `INC`, `DEC`, `ADD`, `SUB`, `MULT`
- Comparisons: `IS_ZERO`, `EQ`

Such that they respect all regular laws of arithmetic, e.g.

```
IS_ZERO ZERO ==> TRUE
IS_ZERO (INC ZERO) ==> FALSE
INC ONE ==> TWO
...
```

Natural Numbers: Implementation

Church numerals: a number *N* is encoded as a combinator that calls a function on an argument *N* times

```
let ONE  = \f x -> f x
let TWO  = \f x -> f (f x)
let THREE = \f x -> f (f (f x))
let FOUR  = \f x -> f (f (f (f x)))
let FIVE  = \f x -> f (f (f (f (f x))))
let SIX   = \f y -> f (f (f (f (f (f x)))))
```



```
let ZERO = \x x -> (\f x -> (\f x -> f x))
```

QUIZ: Church Numerals

Which of these is a valid encoding of ZERO ?

- A: **let** ZERO = \f x -> x
- B: **let** ZERO = \f x -> f
- C: **let** ZERO = \f x -> f x
- D: **let** ZERO = \x -> x
- E: None of the above

Does this function look familiar?

λ -calculus: Increment

```
-- Call 'f' on 'x' one more time than 'n' does
```

```
let INC = \n -> (\f x -> ???)
```

Example:

```
eval inc_zero :
  INC ZERO
=> (\n f x -> f (n f x)) ZERO
=> \f x -> f (ZERO f x)
=> \f x -> f x
=> ONE
```

EXERCISE

Fill in the implementation of ADD so that you get the following behavior

[Click here to try this exercise](#)

```
let ZERO = \f x -> x
let ONE = \f x -> f x
let TWO = \f x -> f (f x)
let INC = \n f x -> f (n f x)
```

```
let ADD = fill_this_in
```

```
eval add_zero_zero:
  ADD ZERO ZERO ==> ZERO
```

```
eval add_zero_one:
  ADD ZERO ONE ==> ONE
```

```
eval add_zero_two:
  ADD ZERO TWO ==> TWO
```

```
eval add_one_zero:
  ADD ONE ZERO ==> ONE
```

```
eval add_one_one:
  ADD ONE ONE ==> TWO
```

```
eval add_two_zero:
  ADD TWO ZERO ==> TWO
```

QUIZ

How shall we implement ADD ?

- A. **let** ADD = \n m -> n INC m
- B. **let** ADD = \n m -> INC n m
- C. **let** ADD = \n m -> n m INC
- D. **let** ADD = \n m -> n (m INC)
- E. **let** ADD = \n m -> n (INC m)

λ -calculus: Addition

```
-- Call 'f' on 'x' exactly 'n + m' times
```

```
let ADD = \n m -> n INC m
```

QUIZ

How shall we implement MULT ?

- A. **let** MULT = \n m -> n ADD m
- B. **let** MULT = \n m -> n (ADD m) ZERO
- C. **let** MULT = \n m -> m (ADD n) ZERO
- D. **let** MULT = \n m -> n (ADD m ZERO)
- E. **let** MULT = \n m -> n (ADD m) ZERO

λ -calculus: Multiplication

```
-- Call 'f' on 'x' exactly 'n * m' times
```

```
let MULT = \n m -> n (ADD m) ZERO
```

Example:

```
eval two_times_three :
  MULT TWO ONE
==> TWO
```

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λ -calculus: Lists

Lets define an API to build lists in the λ -calculus.

An Empty List

```
NIL
```

Constructing a list

A list with 4 elements

```
CONS apple (CONS banana (CONS cantaloupe (CONS dragon NIL)))
```

intuitively CONS h t creates a new list with

- head h
- tail t

Destructing a list

- HEAD l returns the first element of the list
- TAIL l returns the rest of the list

```
HEAD (CONS apple (CONS banana (CONS cantaloupe (CONS dragon NIL))))
=> apple
```

```
TAIL (CONS apple (CONS banana (CONS cantaloupe (CONS dragon NIL))))
=> CONS banana (CONS cantaloupe (CONS dragon NIL))
```

λ -calculus: Lists

```
let NIL = ???
```

```
let CONS = ???
```

```
let HEAD = ???
```

```
let TAIL = ???
```

```
eval exHd:
  HEAD (CONS apple (CONS banana (CONS cantaloupe (CONS dragon NIL))))
=> apple
```

```
eval exTL
  TAIL (CONS apple (CONS banana (CONS cantaloupe (CONS dragon NIL))))
=> CONS banana (CONS cantaloupe (CONS dragon NIL))
```

EXERCISE: Nth

Write an implementation of GetNth such that

- GetNth n l returns the n-th element of the list l

Assume that l has n or more elements

```
let GetNth = ???
```

```
eval nth1 :
  GetNth ZERO (CONS apple (CONS banana (CONS cantaloupe NIL)))
=> apple
```

```
eval nth1 :
  GetNth ONE (CONS apple (CONS banana (CONS cantaloupe NIL)))
=> banana
```

```
eval nth2 :
  GetNth TWO (CONS apple (CONS banana (CONS cantaloupe NIL)))
=> cantaloupe
```

[Click here to try this in elsa](#)

λ -calculus: Recursion

I want to write a function that sums up natural numbers up to n :

```
let SUM = \n -> ... -- 0 + 1 + 2 + ... + n
```

such that we get the following behavior

```
eval exSum0: SUM ZERO ==> ZERO
eval exSum1: SUM ONE ==> ONE
eval exSum2: SUM TWO ==> THREE
eval exSum3: SUM THREE ==> SIX
```

Can we write sum using Church Numerals?

[Click here to try this in Elsa](#)

QUIZ

You can write SUM using numerals but its tedious.

Is this a correct implementation of SUM ?

```
let SUM = \n -> ITE (ISZ n)
  ZERO
  (ADD n (SUM (DEC n)))
```

A. Yes

B. No

No!

- Named terms in Elsa are just syntactic sugar
- To translate an Elsa term to λ -calculus: replace each name with its definition

```
\n -> ITE (ISZ n)
  ZERO
  (ADD n (SUM (DEC n))) -- But SUM is not yet defined!
```

Recursion:

- Inside *this* function
- Want to call the *same* function on `DEC n`

Looks like we can't do recursion!

- Requires being able to refer to functions *by name*,
- But λ -calculus functions are *anonymous*.

Right?

λ -calculus: Recursion

Think again!

Recursion:

Instead of

- ~~Inside *this* function I want to call the same function on~~ `DEC n`

Lets try

- Inside *this* function I want to call *some* function `rec` on `DEC n`
- And BTW, I want `rec` to be the *same* function

Step 1: Pass in the function to call “recursively”

```
let STEP =
  \rec -> \n -> ITE (ISZ n)
                ZERO
                (ADD n (rec (DEC n))) -- Call some rec
```

Step 2: Do some magic to `STEP`, so `rec` is itself

```
\n -> ITE (ISZ n) ZERO (ADD n (rec (DEC n)))
```

That is, obtain a term `MAGIC` such that

```
MAGIC =>> STEP MAGIC
```

λ -calculus: Fixpoint Combinator

Wanted: a λ -term `FIX` such that

- `FIX STEP` calls `STEP` with `FIX STEP` as the first argument:

```
(FIX STEP) =>> STEP (FIX STEP)
```

(In math: a *fixpoint* of a function $f(x)$ is a point x , such that $f(x) = x$)

Once we have it, we can define:

```
let SUM = FIX STEP
```

Then by property of `FIX` we have:

```
SUM  =>>  FIX STEP  =>>  STEP (FIX STEP)  =>>  STEP SUM
```

and so now we compute:

```
eval sum_two:
  SUM TWO
=>> STEP SUM TWO
=>> ITE (ISZ TWO) ZERO (ADD TWO (SUM (DEC TWO)))
=>> ADD TWO (SUM (DEC TWO))
=>> ADD TWO (SUM ONE)
=>> ADD TWO (STEP SUM ONE)
=>> ADD TWO (ITE (ISZ ONE) ZERO (ADD ONE (SUM (DEC ONE))))
=>> ADD TWO (ADD ONE (SUM (DEC ONE)))
=>> ADD TWO (ADD ONE (SUM ZERO))
=>> ADD TWO (ADD ONE (ITE (ISZ ZERO) ZERO (ADD ZERO (SUM DEC ZERO))))
=>> ADD TWO (ADD ONE (ZERO))
=>> THREE
```

How should we define `FIX`???

The Y combinator

Remember Ω ?

```
(\x -> x x) (\x -> x x)
=>b> (\x -> x x) (\x -> x x)
```

This is *self-replicating code*! We need something like this but a bit more involved...

The Y combinator discovered by Haskell Curry:

```
let FIX  = \stp -> (\x -> stp (x x)) (\x -> stp (x x))
```

How does it work?

```
eval fix_step:
  FIX STEP
=>d> (\stp -> (\x -> stp (x x)) (\x -> stp (x x))) STEP
=>b> (\x -> STEP (x x)) (\x -> STEP (x x))
=>b> STEP ((\x -> STEP (x x)) (\x -> STEP (x x)))
--      ^^^^^^^^^^^ this is FIX STEP ^^^^^^^^^^^^^
```

That’s all folks, Haskell Curry was very clever.

Next week: We’ll look at the language named after him (`Haskell`)